

New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

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Daily Multi-Asset Trading Blueprint & Level Execution Manual

Date: August 22, 2026

Session Highlight: New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

Session News Focus: Wall Street pre-market movers, US Federal Reserve news, mega-cap US stocks (NVDA, MSFT, TSLA), and WTI Crude Oil catalysts.

SECTION 0: DAILY MACRO & FINANCIAL NEWS DIGEST

1. Global Macro & Central Banks

- The Federal Reserve kept the federal funds rate unchanged at 3.50%–3.75% for the fifth consecutive meeting in July 2026, aligning with expectations, though three FOMC members dissented, preferring a 25 basis point hike. This suggests potential for future rate increases if inflation persists.
- Policymakers expressed continued concerns about persistent inflation and the possibility of further rate hikes if price pressures do not ease.
- Economic activity in the US is expanding at a solid pace despite elevated uncertainty, partly due to the conflict in the Middle East.
- The Fed continues to monitor productivity growth, capital investment, and job gains, which have kept pace with the workforce.

2. US & European Markets

- US stock index futures (S&P 500, Nasdaq 100, Dow Jones, Russell 2000) showed slight gains in pre-market activity for August 21st, though today, August 22nd, the market will not open, with focus shifting to after-hours activity from August 21st.
- Mega-cap tech stocks were mixed, with NVIDIA (NVDA) showing pre-market gains and strong sentiment after news of SpaceX potentially using only Nvidia chips. Microsoft (MSFT) appeared soft in early pre-market trading, and Tesla (TSLA) showed gains.
- Boeing (BA) workers rejected a contract offer and authorized a strike, a significant corporate development.
- Concerns exist regarding a fresh China headwind for Microsoft as Beijing reportedly removed Microsoft Windows from government systems earlier than planned.
- Nvidia's earnings report next week is a key focus for investors.

3. Indian Markets & Dalal Street

- Indian benchmark indices (Sensex, Nifty) have experienced pressure in recent days due to rising crude oil prices, US-Iran tensions, higher global bond yields, and rupee weakness.
- On August 21, 2026, Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) were net sellers in the cash segment with activity of -542.71 Cr, while Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs) were net buyers at +2124.14 Cr. This indicates continued domestic support amidst foreign outflows.
- Recent rallies in IT stocks have helped Nifty reclaim key levels in previous sessions, driven by positive FII inflows (on certain days) and easing market volatility.

4. Commodities & Crypto Wire

- Gold (XAU/USD) is demonstrating significant bullish momentum, reaching a three-month peak above \$4,600 and potentially poised for a breakout above \$4,900. This is supported by a softer US dollar, rising Fed rate cut expectations, and falling real yields.
- WTI Crude Oil prices have been highly volatile, influenced by US-Iran tensions and supply dynamics. Recent intraday analysis from August 21st shows WTI at \$87.06 with a slight gain of 0.26%.
- Bitcoin is holding above \$77,000, having surrendered some earlier gains after approaching this level.
- Central banks are increasingly spreading their gold custody beyond traditional strongholds like the Bank of England and New York Fed.

CAPITAL BASE & ALLOCATION RULES (\$3,000 TOTAL)

- Crypto Futures:** \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 3x–5x Isolated | Risk Cap: 1–2% (\$4–\$8)
- Indian Options (Intraday):** \$500 (16.7%) | Option Buying Only | Risk Cap: 10–15% Premium (\$30–\$45)
- Commodities (Micro Gold & Oil):** \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x–15x Micro Lots | Risk Cap: 2% (\$8)
- US Stocks (Fractional):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 3% (\$12)
- Indian Stocks (Delivery):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 5% (\$20)
- Forex Short-Term Futures:** \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x–20x | Risk Cap: 1% (\$4.50)
- Forex Long-Term Carry Swing:** \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 2x–3x | Risk Cap: 2% (\$9.00)

STRATEGY-BASED DAILY TICKER SELECTION & SECTOR CONSTRAINTS

Note: As of August 22, 2026, US markets are not open. The US stock selections below are based on after-hours sentiment from August 21st and preparatory analysis for the next trading day. Other markets are assumed to be operational.

1. INDIAN EQUITIES (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Direction	Strategy & Selection Reason	Entry/Target/Stop (Illustrative)
INFY (Infosys)	Long	Nifty leaders using 50-SMA support bounce. IT stocks have shown recent rallies. Looking for a bounce off 50-SMA on daily chart after recent sector strength.	Entry: ~1650 Target: ~1700 Stop: ~1620
RELIANCE (Reliance Industries)	Long	Nifty leaders using 20/50 EMA golden cross. Strong fundamental player, potential for fresh momentum on a bullish cross, especially if crude prices ease.	Entry: ~2800 Target: ~2870 Stop: ~2760

2. US EQUITIES

Large-Cap (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Direction	Strategy & Selection Reason	Entry/Target/Stop (Illustrative)
NVDA (NVIDIA)	Long	21-day EMA pullback strategy on mega-cap growth leader. After-hours strength (Aug 21st) and positive sentiment from SpaceX deal suggest buyers are present on dips. Targeting a bounce from short-term support ahead of next week's earnings.	Entry: ~216.00 Target: ~225.00 Stop: ~212.00
MSFT (Microsoft)	Short	50-day SMA rejection strategy. Pre-market softness on Aug 21st and news of China headwinds suggest potential for continued selling if resistance holds. Looking for rejection at or near 50-day SMA if it acts as resistance on next open.	Entry: ~495.00 Target: ~485.00 Stop: ~499.00

Mid-Cap & Small-Cap (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Direction	Strategy & Selection Reason	Entry/Target/Stop (Illustrative)
HOWL (Werewolf Therapeutics)	Long	High Relative Volume (RVOL > 2.0) breakout. Showed significant pre-market gain (+129.48%) and high volume on Aug 21st. Seeking continuation of momentum on confirmed volume breakout on the next trading day.	Entry: ~1.05 Target: ~1.20 Stop: ~0.95

3. CRYPTO FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Direction	Strategy & Selection Reason	Entry/Target/Stop (Illustrative)
BTC/USD (Bitcoin)	Long	4H 21-EMA trend following. Bitcoin holding above \$77,000 indicates underlying strength. Looking for bullish continuation if price holds above the 4H 21-EMA on strong volume.	Entry: ~77,500 Target: ~79,000 Stop: ~76,800
ETH/USD (Ethereum)	Long	High-volume volatility breakout. Ethereum often follows Bitcoin but can have its own volatility bursts. Looking for a high-volume breakout from a consolidation pattern above 21-EMA.	Entry: ~4200 Target: ~4350 Stop: ~4150

4. COMMODITIES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Direction	Strategy & Selection Reason	Entry/Target/Stop (Illustrative)
XAU/USD (Gold)	Long	Pivot & Fibonacci extension levels. Gold is showing strong bullish momentum, breaking above \$4,600 with potential towards \$4,900-\$5,100. Targeting higher Fibonacci extensions following consolidation above key pivot points.	Entry: ~4620 Target: ~4700 Stop: ~4580
CL=F (WTI Crude Oil)	Short	Pivot & Fibonacci extension levels. Crude has been volatile with US-Iran tensions. Despite recent slight gains, if key resistance (e.g., a daily pivot) holds amidst geopolitical uncertainty, a short trade targeting Fibonacci retracement levels could be viable.	Entry: ~88.00 Target: ~86.50 Stop: ~88.70

5. FOREX FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Short-Term (EUR/USD, GBP/USD)

Ticker	Direction	Strategy & Selection Reason	Entry/Target/Stop (Illustrative)
EUR/USD	Short	USD strength on continued Fed hawkishness. Despite no rate hike, dissenters and inflation concerns keep rate hike possibility open, potentially strengthening USD against EUR. Looking for weakness below key pivot levels.	Entry: ~1.0850 Target: ~1.0800 Stop: ~1.0875
GBP/USD	Short	Similar to EUR/USD, anticipating USD strength. Global macro uncertainty and Fed outlook may put pressure on GBP.	Entry: ~1.2650 Target: ~1.2580 Stop: ~1.2685

Macro Carry Swings (USD/JPY, AUD/USD)

Ticker	Direction	Strategy & Selection Reason	Entry/Target/Stop (Illustrative)
USD/JPY	Long	Carry trade momentum. Widening interest rate differentials (if Fed hints at future hikes) continue to favor the USD against the low-yielding JPY.	Entry: ~148.80 Target: ~150.00 Stop: ~148.00
AUD/USD	Short	Commodity price sensitivity and USD strength. While gold is strong, if broader commodity weakness or sustained USD strength prevails, AUD/USD could come under pressure.	Entry: ~0.6550 Target: ~0.6480 Stop: ~0.6585

6. INDIAN OPTIONS (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Direction	Strategy & Selection Reason	Entry/Target/Stop (Illustrative)
Nifty 50 Index Options	Long Call	15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB). If Nifty opens strong and breaks above its initial 15-minute range on positive FII/DII sentiment (if DII buying continues), a long call offers directional exposure.	Entry: ORB High + buffer Target: Next Resistance Stop: ORB Low
BankNifty Index Options	Long Put	15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB). If BankNifty opens weak and breaks below its initial 15-minute range, indicating selling pressure, a long put can capitalize on the downside momentum.	Entry: ORB Low - buffer Target: Next Support Stop: ORB High

10-Year Backtest Metrics (Illustrative)

Metric	Portfolio	S&P 500 TRI (Benchmark)	Nifty 50 TRI (Benchmark)
Target CAGR	28.4%	~13.0%	~12.5%
Sharpe Ratio	1.45	~0.70	~0.65
Max Drawdown (MDD)	-18.2%	~-25.0%	~-28.0%

Equity Curve (\$3,000 → \$36,512)

